and buy-in of nearly all states in the international system. Nonpopulist leaders also suffer fewer political costs than populists from meaningful engagement with IOs.

For nonpopulist leaders, the stakes can be high when it comes to the functionality of IOs. These institutions provide critical platforms for influencing international policymaking, enabling leaders to amplify their voices on the global stage. Beyond policymaking, IOs deliver tangible benefits, such as financial aid, favorable trade terms, and enhanced security measures. Without well-functioning IOs, nonpopulist leaders risk losing these advantages, which can weaken their domestic standing and international clout. While not all nonpopulist leaders fully support IOs, their critiques of IOs are often targeted to specific institutions and are not as widespread or programmatic as those of populist leaders.

Recognizing the importance of strong IOs, nonpopulist leaders often play an active role in insulating these institutions against populist threats. Whether by directly engaging in strategies to counter populist resistance or by supporting bureaucrats and IO leaders in their efforts, nonpopulist leaders aim to safeguard the integrity and effectiveness of global governance. In doing so, they help ensure that IOs remain resilient actors capable of advancing international cooperation in an increasingly polarized world. However, this does not mean they support all strategies IOs undertake to keep populist leaders in the fold. They may, for example, oppose attempts to appease populist leaders by redistributing voting shares or issuing large loans. Such steps can invoke fairness concerns.

2.5 Scope Conditions

Populists frequently target IOs with hostility, and as we demonstrate throughout this book, IOs respond with a repertoire of strategies to counter these challenges. These responses highlight a surprising resilience on the part of IOs, helping to explain why these institutions have persisted through turbulent times. However, the effectiveness and applicability of these strategies are not universal; they depend on a range of conditions tied to the characteristics of both IOs and the populist threats they face. Here, we outline the key scope conditions that shape whether and how IOs can respond to threats to their writ.